PRACTICE
CONNECTION

journal

Welcome.

We all long for meaningful connection.

This journal is designed to be used alongside the Practice Connection cards. Together, they invite you to imagine the kinds of relationships you want, notice the patterns that shape your responses and practice new ways of relating.

As you move through these pages, be gentle with yourself. Every pattern you notice once helped protect you in some way. Curiosity will take you further than self-judgment.

I hope this journal becomes a safe place to grow the courage, skills, and capacity for the kind of relationships you long for.

A note on support: Practice Connection is designed to support reflection and practice, not to replace therapy or mental health care. If a practice brings up more than you want to hold on your own, consider reaching out to a therapist or someone you trust.

VISUALIZATION

Change is a courageous act of radical imagination
- Marcelo Bronstein

Write (or draw) about a day in the life from the future when you feel more connected, whatever that may mean for you. Start from when you wake up and walk through the day, paying attention to the small and big moments of connection.

You can be as detailed or dreamy as you like. Feel free to use the prompts below to guide you, if helpful:

- Who is in your life (and who isn't)?
- What are your roles and relationships with them?
- How often and how long do you typically see each other, and in what ways (in-person, text, online, special occasion etc.)?
- How do they support you emotionally or practically?
- How do you feel during and after spending time with them?

WHAT YOU'RE LONGING FOR

Based on the visualization, what kinds of connections do you long for? Below are some examples, but by no means exhaustive:

- More depth in a few close relationships
- More casual, everyday moments with neighbours or colleagues
- New friendships with shared purpose or play
- A sense of belonging to a group, tradition, or place
- Connection to myself, my body, or something bigger

NOTICE (1/5)

Understand where you are today

When a moment of connection doesn't go the way you hoped, use these questions to better understand what might have been happening.

- What happened?
- How did I feel?
- What did I notice in my body?
- What was my mind saying?
- What action did I take, or want to take?
- Have I seen this reaction before?

Example 1:
I texted a friend to hang out. It's been a day, and I haven't heard back. I notice I keep checking my phone and wondering if I did something to upset her the last time we hung out. I really want to send another text, but I don't. Instead, I eat a bag of chips and decide not to reach out to her again for a while. Looking back, I notice I often assume silence means I've done something wrong and pull away before I have the chance to find out.

Example 2:
I shared something I've been struggling with with a friend. Afterwards, I felt flooded and overwhelmed. My mind kept wondering if I'd shared too much and what they must think of me. When I got home, I went straight to bed even though it was the afternoon. For the next little while, I found myself avoiding that friend because I felt embarrassed. Looking back, I notice this tends to happen after I've been vulnerable.

NOTICE (2/5)

Understand where you are today

When a moment of connection doesn't go the way you hoped, use these questions to better understand what might have been happening.

- What happened?
- How did I feel?
- What did I notice in my body?
- What was my mind saying?
- What action did I take, or want to take?
- Have I seen this reaction before?

NOTICE (3/5)

Understand where you are today

When a moment of connection doesn't go the way you hoped, use these questions to better understand what might have been happening.

- What happened?
- How did I feel?
- What did I notice in my body?
- What was my mind saying?
- What action did I take, or want to take?
- Have I seen this reaction before?

NOTICE (4/5)

Understand where you are today

When a moment of connection doesn't go the way you hoped, use these questions to better understand what might have been happening.

- What happened?
- How did I feel?
- What did I notice in my body?
- What was my mind saying?
- What action did I take, or want to take?
- Have I seen this reaction before?

NOTICE (5/5)

Understand where you are today

When a moment of connection doesn't go the way you hoped, use these questions to better understand what might have been happening.

- What happened?
- How did I feel?
- What did I notice in my body?
- What was my mind saying?
- What action did I take, or want to take?
- Have I seen this reaction before?

WHAT ARE YOU BEGINNING TO NOTICE?

As you look back across these pages:

- What stands out?
- What are you curious to try next?

PRACTICE (1/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

PRACTICE (2/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

PRACTICE (3/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

PRACTICE (4/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

PRACTICE (5/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

PRACTICE (6/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

PRACTICE (7/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

PRACTICE (8/8)

Practice creates change

If you're using the Practice Connection cards, choose one or two cards to practice this week. Then use these pages to reflect.

For the week ended _____:

What practice(s) did I try this week?
What did I notice?
What did I learn?
What do I want to remember and bring forward with me?
What do I want to try next? (it can be the same practice)

CELEBRATE!

Pause and notice how far you've come

Use this page to celebrate the small, courageous steps you took toward connection. Whether things went as planned or not, what are you proud of? What did you learn? How have you grown?

WORDS TO DESCRIBE YOUR EXPERIENCE

Use this anytime you're stuck for words

FEELINGS

Accepted

Appreciated

Burdensome

Curious

Guarded

Invisible

Longing

Misunderstood

Overwhelmed

Rejected

Relaxed

Resentful

Safe

Seen

Self-conscious

Supported

Uncertain

BODY SENSATIONS

Blank mind

Clenched jaw

Feeling frozen

Heavy tongue

Holding my breath

Knots or butterflies in my stomach

Numbness

Racing heart

Racing mind

Relaxed shoulders

Steady breath

Sweaty palms

Tight chest